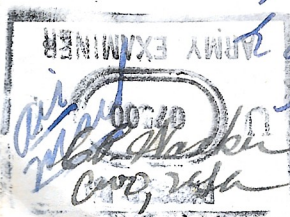


Prt. O.T. Hoffstetter
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A.P.O. 635
% Postmaster.
New York N.Y.



Miss MARTHA DARROUGH
LUTHERAN Hosp. School of Nursing
St. Louis 18 Mo.



Feb, 11/1848
England.

Dear Martha

Well said

I finally got your letter
after this chased me
all over England. but
was very happy to hear
from you.

The news here
is very slow. I got the
most ludded job in
the army. I had to
I have been spending
all my nights washing
& sewing cloths. Say
I will make a good
husband when this

War is over. I can work
in the kitchen + wash + sew.
is there any thing else. Oh yes
the babies well that is not
in my department.

Boy I learned that you
can get up in the morning
any day you put your
mind to it. I get
up every day in a cold
barracks and walk
about $1/4$ of a mile to
breakfast. Boy is that
a cold walk.

Did you see the picture
"The marcell of Margen Creek."
Say that was a good picture
at least for the army.

I am glad you like the family. Say did you know that my ~~father~~ is thing about getting in the service. I think it is the coast guard. I guess he is like your father. I read that list of food does my mouth water.

I will go to show now to get the water away. I will write later.

We had some meat
baf and coca.

You said that you like to see England.

Well, I guess you would like it. But to hear the boys here you would

not.

That dress, of your sounds
 very good. My mother
 + Dad both write that
 they liked your dress. My
 mother would not be
 this like that but Dad
 sure surprise me when
 he told me about it.
 I know you made
 a good with ~~when~~.
 And as for men well
 you such read her
 letter.

So you went ice
 skating. my sister is
 just learning and I
 do not know the first

5.

about it. I saw in the paper that the mid-west had a big snow storm.

I hope you do not mind. But I let a boy in the barracks read parts of your letter. His name is Noe & we call him Shorty because he is 5 feet tall. We have a great time to gether. He is from the South & we hold a civil war all over. He said that I much annoy you.

I thought of that a lot.

We had a very big and full moon the last couple nights. I was just

wondering what you
were doing & if you were
thinking of me.

I woke up last
night in the middle of
my dream. I was this
close to hold you in my
arms as I have so many
many times. But for the
first time in a long time
I really would like to
be at home. I think we
can do some thing about the
ring.

Well I better close now
before I get in to much of
this. I love to say the things
not to write them.

7.

I hope that you can
come to the house again.

I will write more
later. But time here
is hard to find.

With Love
and lots of it
Hop.

P.S. Sothy will write some
to you. I hope you do
not mind.

Dear Miss Parrough

for the first time in my life I dont know quite what to say to a lady, because in reading one of your letters to Hop. I find you are far more superior to me for writing letters.

The most interesting part about you is I find you are a nurse. I work in hospitals myself in civilian life.

I have just finished debating the question of the North and South so you see I dont know much to write about now because these Yanks have been putting

up a desperate stand to
dissolution this rebel, but
as long as Hop is with
me I dont think we can
loose the debate. My best
regards to you,
put Richard Noe